

MB 305: Business Communication

Course Code	MB 305
Course Name	Business Communication
L-T-P-C	3-0-0-3
Prerequisites	NA
Intended for	IMBA
Mutual Exclusion	NA
Approval	59th BoA (Apr 2025), in the Integrated MBA (IMBA) curriculum; 60th BoA (Jun 2025)

Preamble

This course develops essential managerial communication skills with a focus on strategic, effective communication in professional contexts. Through case studies, role-plays, and theoretical insights, students will enhance their ability to convey ideas clearly and lead with impact. With the rise in Generative AI, communication methods are evolving rapidly. While these tools can enhance productivity, they also introduce cognitive challenges. Students will explore how to engage with such technologies critically—using them to augment, not replace, their communication abilities—preparing them for the demands of a tech-driven workplace.

Course Modules

- **Mastering Communication Skills in the Era of AI:** Historical evolution of workplace communication, the impact of digital transformation and AI on communication norms, Human vs. machine communication: key distinctions, Capabilities and limitations of AI in communication, Examples of AI-driven communication tasks in business settings, Why Human Communication Still Matters, effective and ineffective use of AI in business communication. (4 Hours)
- **Foundations of Effective Communication:** This module introduces essential principles of effective communication within organisations. It addresses communication fundamentals, common barriers and solutions, speaking and listening skills, and an audience-focused approach. Students will develop the ability to create clear, concise, and impactful messages suited to professional contexts. (6 Hours)
- **Strategic Persuasion and Influence for Business Communication:** This module introduces students to important strategies for persuasive communication. It combines ideas from different fields like rhetoric, strategy, and negotiation. Students will learn key frameworks such as Aristotle's persuasion model, Toulmin's argument method, and storytelling techniques. These concepts will be explained using real-life case studies. The module also covers topics like "Radical Candor," "Using Humor in Communication," "Being Authentic in the Age of AI," and "Understanding Your Audience." (6 Hours)
- **AI-Enabled Public Speaking and Presentation Skills:** This module centers on mastering the art of preparing and delivering impactful presentations. Students will learn to create a compelling balance between data and narrative by focusing on content structuring, design principles, multimedia integration, and storytelling techniques. The course also covers essential elements of non-verbal communication, including the use of gestures and posture, managing audience questions, and honing public speaking skills. As a practical component, students will collaborate to prepare and deliver group presentations. Additionally, the module highlights the role of AI tools in enhancing personalized, interactive, and efficient instruction, positioning them as valuable resources in modern communication education. (12 Hours)
- **Master Storytelling aided with AI Tools as assets:** This module discusses how AI tools play a pivotal role in modern education by enabling personalized, interactive, and efficient instruction in both written communication and public speaking, making them essential assets in today's learning environment. (6 Hours)
- **Modern Interview Techniques and the Use of Technology:** The final module focuses on developing the communication skills and strategies essential for succeeding in interviews. Delivered in an interactive workshop format, this module will include role-plays, mock interviews, and personalized feedback sessions. Key topics include cross-cultural communication, aligning with industry-specific narratives, effective articulation techniques, and structured approaches to handling interview questions. The module also introduces students to cutting-edge tools, including VR-based technologies designed to enhance interview readiness. Demonstrations from partner startups will showcase how such tools can simulate real-life interview scenarios and support skill development in a dynamic, tech-enabled environment. (8 Hours)

Text Books

1. Bovee, Courtland L., John V. Thill and Roshan Lal Raina. *Business Communication Today*. Tenth Edition. Delhi: Pearson, 2018.

References

1. Morgan, N., Cialdini, R. B., Review, H. B., Tannen, D. (2013). *HBR's 10 Must Reads on Communication* (with Featured Article "The Necessary Art of Persuasion," by Jay A.)
2. Ethan Mollick, *Co-Intelligence: Living and Working with AI*, WH Allen; Penguin Random House Ireland Limited, 2024.
3. Robert Cialdini, *Influence: The Psychology of Persuasion*, Harper Business, HarperCollins India Private Limited, 2021.
4. *The Elements of Style* by William Strunk Jr. and E.B. White.